

Skills

Assessing Respiration: Rate, Rhythm, and Effort

Checklist

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S = Satisfactory U = Unsatisfactory NP = Not Performed

Step	S	U	NP	Comments
Verified health care provider's orders.	☐	☐	☐	
Gathered necessary equipment and supplies.	☐	☐	☐	
Performed hand hygiene. Donned appropriate personal protective equipment (PPE) based on the patient's need for isolation precautions or risk of exposure to bodily fluids.	☐	☐	☐	
Introduced self to patient and family.	☐	☐	☐	
Identified patient using two identifiers.	☐	☐	☐	
Explained the procedure to the patient and ensured that he or she agreed to the treatments.	☐	☐	☐	
Assessed for factors that could affect respiratory rate.	☐	☐	☐	
Helped patient into appropriate position.	☐	☐	☐	
Ensured patient's chest was visible.	☐	☐	☐	
Placed patient's forearm or own hand over lower chest or upper abdomen.	☐	☐	☐	
Observed a complete respiratory cycle.	☐	☐	☐	
Looked at watch, and took respiratory rate properly.	☐	☐	☐	
Noted depth of patient's respirations properly.	☐	☐	☐	

Noted respiratory rhythm. ☐ ☐ ☐

Observed for dyspnea, and asked patient to compare shortness of breath with usual breathing patterns. ☐ ☐ ☐

Replaced patient's bed linen, and discussed findings with patient. ☐ ☐ ☐

Helped patient to comfortable position, and placed personal items within reach. ☐ ☐ ☐

Placed call light within easy reach, and ensured patient knew how to use it. ☐ ☐ ☐

Raised top side rails and lowered bed to ensure patient's safety. ☐ ☐ ☐

Disinfected ear pieces and diaphragm of stethoscope with an organization-approved equipment cleaner, disposed of used supplies and equipment, and left patient's room tidy. ☐ ☐ ☐

Removed and disposed of gloves, and performed hand hygiene. ☐ ☐ ☐

Compared respirations with baseline, usual rate, depth, and rhythm, and correlated these with pulse oximetry and ABG measurements. ☐ ☐ ☐

Documented and reported patient's response and outcomes. ☐ ☐ ☐

Learner: _____
Evaluator: _____
Date: _____

Signature: _____
Signature: _____